Year	Muslim vote for Congress (%)	Muslim vote for BJP (%)	Muslim vote for Others (%)
1971	59	0	41
1996	36	2	62
1998	32	6	62
1999	40	7	53
2004	36	7	57
2009	38	4	58
2014	38	8	54

Source: CSDS Data Unit, National Election Studies conducted by CSDS
Note: Figures weighted by actual vote share of parties in the respective years.

Muslim support for Congress was much greater in states where it was locked in a straight contest with BJP.

States with . . .	Muslim vote for Congress (%)	Muslim vote for BJP (%)	Muslim vote for Others (%)
Cong vs BJP direct fight (Bipolar)	73	19	8
Cong vs BJP vs Others (Multipolar)	37	7	56

Source: National Election Studies, 2014, conducted by Lokniti, CSDS
Note: Bipolar states are Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Maharashtra (BJP–SS vs Cong–NCP).

On the back of massive and unprecedented support from Hindu Upper Castes and OBCs, the overall Hindu support for the BJP touched an all-time high of 36 per cent, rendering any minority consolidation behind non-BJP parties almost ineffective. Never in the past had Hindu support for the BJP crossed the 30 per cent mark.